Iteration I2: Authenticating Users

What does it mean to add login support for administrators of our store?

- We need to provide a form that allows them to enter a username and password.
- Once they're logged in, we need to record that fact somehow for the rest of the session (or until they log out).
- We need to restrict access to the administrative parts of the application, allowing only people who are logged in to administer the store.

We could put all of the logic into a single controller, but it makes more sense to split it into two—a session controller to support logging in and out and a controller to welcome administrators:

```
depot> bin/rails generate controller Sessions new create destroy
depot> bin/rails generate controller Admin index
```

The `SessionsController#create` action will need to record something in `session` to say that an administrator is logged in. Let's have it store the ID of that person's `User` object using the key `:user_id`. The login code looks like this:

rails7/depot_r/app/controllers/sessions_controller.rb

```
  def create
»   user = User.find_by(name: params[:name])
»   if user&.authenticate(params[:password])
»     session[:user_id] = user.id
»     redirect_to admin_url
»   else
»     redirect_to login_url, alert: "Invalid user/password combination"
»   end
  end
```

This code makes use of the Ruby Safe Navigation Operator, which checks to see if a variable has a value of `nil` before trying to call the method.